

Meta WhatsApp — Credential Setup Guide

This guide walks you through getting the WhatsApp Business credentials our team needs to connect your AI agent to WhatsApp. No coding required — it's all clicks in Meta's web dashboards.

Start this first. Meta business verification and message-template approval each take **24–48 hours** and sometimes get rejected once for minor reasons. The earlier you begin, the smoother launch day goes.

What we need from you (the end goal)

By the end of this guide you'll hand us six things:

#	Credential	Looks like
1	App ID	a long number, e.g. 1234567890123456
2	App Secret	a 32-character string
3	Phone Number ID	a long number
4	WhatsApp Business Account ID	a long number
5	Permanent Access Token	a long string starting with EAA...
6	Verify Token	a password you make up (see Step 6)

Don't worry about what these mean — just follow the steps and collect them in a note. How to send them securely is at the bottom.

Step 1 — Create a Meta Business Account

1. Go to <https://business.facebook.com>
2. Click **Create Account** (top right)
3. Enter your **business name**, **your name**, and **work email**
4. Follow the prompts to finish

If your business already has a Meta Business account (used for Facebook/Instagram ads), you can reuse it — just make sure you have **admin** access.

Step 2 — Verify your business

This unlocks production messaging (without it you're limited to test numbers).

1. In Business Settings, go to **Security Center**
2. Click **Start Verification**
3. Provide your business details and upload a supporting document — typically one of: - Business registration / incorporation certificate - GST certificate - Utility bill in the business name
4. Submit

Lead time: 1–2 business days. You can continue with the steps below while this is pending.

Step 3 — Create a Meta App

1. Go to <https://developers.facebook.com/apps>
 2. Click **Create App**
 3. For "What do you want your app to do?" choose **Other** → **Next**
 4. Select app type **Business** → **Next**
 5. Name it (e.g. "*YourBrand WhatsApp*"), pick your Business Account → **Create App**
-

Step 4 — Add the WhatsApp product

1. On your new app's dashboard, find **WhatsApp** in the product list → click **Set up**
2. Select your Business Account when prompted
3. You'll land on the **WhatsApp** → **API Setup** page

On this page you'll already see: - A **test phone number** Meta gives you for free - A **Phone Number ID** ← *this is credential #3* - A **WhatsApp Business Account ID** ← *this is credential #4* - A **temporary access token** (valid 24h — we'll replace it in Step 7)

Note down the Phone Number ID and WhatsApp Business Account ID.

Step 5 — Get your App ID and App Secret

1. In the left sidebar: **App settings** → **Basic**
 2. **App ID** is at the top ← *credential #1*
 3. Next to **App Secret**, click **Show**, enter your password ← *credential #2*
-

Step 6 — Create a Verify Token (you invent this)

The "Verify Token" isn't something Meta gives you — it's a secret password **you choose** that we configure on both sides so Meta and our server can trust each other.

1. Make up a strong random string — e.g. `veerox-wh-9f3k2p7q-secure`
2. Write it down ← *credential #6*

That's it. Just pick one and keep it with the others.

Step 7 — Generate a Permanent Access Token

The token from Step 4 expires in 24 hours. We need a permanent one via a **System User**.

1. Go to **Business Settings** (<https://business.facebook.com/settings>)
2. Left sidebar: **Users** → **System Users**
3. Click **Add**, name it (e.g. "Veerox API"), role **Admin** → **Create**
4. With the system user selected, click **Add Assets** → **Apps** → select your app → enable **Full control** → **Save**
5. Click **Generate New Token** - Select your app - Token expiration: **Never** - Under permissions, tick: `whatsapp_business_messaging` and `whatsapp_business_management`
6. Click **Generate** → copy the token (starts with EAA. . .) ← *credential #5*

Important: Meta shows this token **only once**. Copy it immediately. If you lose it, just generate a new one.

Step 8 — (Optional but recommended) Submit message templates

If you'll ever message customers *first* (outside a 24-hour reply window) — e.g. appointment reminders — those messages must use pre-approved templates.

1. Go to **WhatsApp Manager** → **Message Templates** → **Create Template**
2. Create two simple ones to start (our team will tell you the exact wording): - `appointment_confirmation` - `lead_followup`
3. Submit for review

Lead time: 24–48 hours. First submissions are often rejected for small reasons (a stray emoji, wrong category). Budget for one re-submission. Submit early even if you won't use them until later.

Step 9 — Add a real phone number (when ready for production)

The free test number only messages a handful of pre-approved testers. For real customers:

1. On the **WhatsApp** → **API Setup** page, click **Add phone number**
2. Use a number that is **not** already registered on the WhatsApp consumer/Business app

3. Verify it via SMS or call
4. This gives you a new **Phone Number ID** — send us the updated one

How to send us the credentials (securely)

These are sensitive — anyone with them can send messages as your business. **Please do not paste them into plain WhatsApp or email.**

Preferred options (any one): - A password manager shared note (1Password, Bitwarden "Send", etc.) - An encrypted file we'll provide - A temporary secret-sharing link (e.g. <https://onetimesecret.com>)

Send us this filled-in checklist:

App ID:	_____
App Secret:	_____
Phone Number ID:	_____
WhatsApp Business Account ID:	_____
Permanent Access Token:	EAA_____
Verify Token (you chose):	_____

Quick troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
"Token expired"	You used the Step 4 temporary token. Generate the permanent one (Step 7).
Can't add a phone number	The number is already on the regular WhatsApp app — delete that account first, or use a fresh number.
Template rejected	Check the category is correct and remove emojis/links. Resubmit.
Business verification stuck	Make sure the uploaded document name exactly matches your business name.

Questions at any step? Send us a screenshot — happy to point you to the right button.